

To apply to be on the list, a company must have a minimum of 1,250,000 publicly traded shares and the bid price of at least \$4 per share. Other requirements include a minimum of 2,200 total shareholders, or 550 total shareholders with 1.1 million average trading volume over the past year.

The pretax earnings requirement is a combined \$11 million for the past three years, with \$2.2 million in earnings for the prior two years. Over the last 12 months, the average market capitalization must be \$550 million, with at least 1.1 million in trading volume. There cannot be a net loss in the previous three years, and aggregate cash flow, revenues, and operating income standards must be met.

NYSE MKT and NYSE Amex Options Formerly known as the American Stock Exchange (AMEX), the NYSE united with AMEX in 2008. Both the NYSE MKT and NYSE Amex Options are owned by Intercontinental Exchange.

The AMEX market was renamed NYSE MKT in 2012. It was created with young, high-growth companies in mind. Companies listed on the NYSE MKT benefit from using the NYSE's fully integrated platform. This union enhanced the NYSE's role in exchange traded funds (ETFs), cash equities, options, and more.

Other exchanges Other exchanges include the Philadelphia Stock Exchange (PHLX), Chicago Stock Exchange (CHX), International Securities Exchange (ISE), National Stock Exchange (NSX), and the Boston Stock Exchange (BSE).

In Canada

The Toronto Stock Exchange (TSX) is the largest exchange market in Canada. It is overseen by the Ontario Securities Commission. There is also the Canadian Securities Exchange (CSE) as well as stock markets in Vancouver and Montreal.

VALUATION AND REGULATION

Stock indexes attempt to measure the value of a section of the stock market. Indexes are tools used by financial managers and investors.

Nasdaq Composite

The Nasdaq Composite is an index of the securities listed on the exchange.

Standard & Poor's 500 (S&P)

The S&P is comprised of the top 500 companies that are listed on either the NYSE or the Nasdaq. They are the largest companies, based on market capitalization.

Dow Jones Industrial Average (DJIA)

The DJIA includes the 30 largest (and most influential) companies in the US. The companies are considered to have 'blue chip' stocks. They are very large corporations with good reputations. With only 30 companies included in the index, the DJIA isn't considered an indicator for the entire market. But the companies are considered stable and offer the possibility of dividends as well as less risk for an investor.

The Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)

The SEC is designed to protect investors and to maintain orderly and efficient markets. Public companies are required to disclose financial information to the public. The goal is to give investors accurate data so they have what they need to make investment decisions.

The SEC oversees the securities exchanges, brokers, dealers, funds, and investment advisors to push transparency for the public. The SEC is authorized to bring action to companies (and individuals) who break the laws. For example, insider trading, deceptive information about securities, and accounting fraud.